The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

12th February 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

1. Foster: (प्रोत्साहित करना)

- ➔ Meaning: To encourage the development or growth of something.
- ➔ Synonyms: Nurture, promote, support
- ➔ Antonyms: Hinder, suppress, discourage
- ➔ Example: The new policy aims to foster innovation in the renewable energy sector.

2. Retaliatory (प्रतिशोधी)

- ➔ Meaning: Done in response to an action, especially a harmful or unfriendly one.
- ➔ Synonyms: Reprisal, retributive, vengeful
- ➔ Antonyms: Forgiving, conciliatory, yielding
- ➔ Example: The country imposed retaliatory tariffs on imports following the trade dispute.

3. Ripple (लहराना /प्रभाव डालना)

- ➔ Meaning: A gradual spreading effect of an action or event.
- ➔ Synonyms: Wave, consequence, chain reaction
- ➔ Antonyms: Stagnation, stillness, inactivity
- ➔ Example: The rise in steel prices created a ripple effect, increasing the costs of automobiles and appliances.

4. Constrained (प्रतिबंधित /बाध्य)

- ➔ Meaning: Restricted or limited in scope or action.
- ➔ Synonyms: Restricted, hindered, restrained
- ➔ Antonyms: Unrestricted, free, uninhibited
- ➔ Example: Developing countries are often constrained by financial limitations in their climate action efforts.

5. Repercussions (प्रभाव/परिणाम)

- ➔ Meaning: Unintended consequences or effects of an action.
- ➔ Synonyms: Consequences, ramifications, fallout
- ➔ Antonyms: Causes, origins, triviality
- ➔ Example: The tariffs had serious economic repercussions, leading to higher inflation.

6. Exorbitant (अत्यधिक /बेहद महँगा)

- Meaning: Unreasonably high or excessive (especially in cost).
- Synonyms: Outrageous, excessive, steep
- Antonyms: Reasonable, moderate, fair
- Example: The exorbitant cost of green hydrogen production remains a challenge for widespread adoption.

7. Pervasive (व्यापक/सर्वव्यापी)

- ➔ Meaning: Spreading widely throughout an area or group.
- ➔ Synonyms: Omnipresent, all-encompassing, widespread
- ➔ Antonyms: Limited, localized, confined
- ➔ Example: The influence of climate policies is pervasive across all industrial sectors.

8. Impetus (प्रेरणा/गति देने वाला कारक)

- ➔ Meaning: A force or influence that makes something happen or develop faster.
- ➔ Synonyms: Momentum, drive, stimulus
- ➔ Antonyms: Hindrance, deterrent, obstacle
- ➔ Example: The COP29 summit provided fresh impetus for global climate action.

9. Requisite (अनिवार्य /आवश्यक)

- ➔ Meaning: Necessary or required for a particular purpose.
- ➔ Synonyms: Essential, mandatory, indispensable
- ➔ Antonyms: Optional, unnecessary, dispensable
- ➔ Example: Technical expertise is a requisite for the successful implementation of carbon credit programs.

10. Flaccid (नम; ढीला)

- ➔ Meaning: Lacking firmness or stiffness.
- ➔ Synonyms: Limp, weak, slack
- ➔ Antonyms: Firm, stiff, rigid
- ➔ Example: The plant's leaves became flaccid due to the lack of water.

VOCABULARY

One-word substitute:

1. A sentimental longing for the past:
Nostalgia

2. A harsh, discordant mixture of sounds:
Cacophony

3. Open to more than one interpretation; unclear:
Ambiguous

4. A person who pretends to have beliefs or virtues they do not actually possess:
Hypocrite

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Set out
Meaning: Begin a journey or an activity

2. Run down
Meaning: Criticize someone or something unfairly / Decline in condition or power

3. Rope in
Meaning: Persuade or convince someone to participate

4. Stir up
Meaning: Provoke or incite strong emotions or trouble

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. A big shot

Meaning: An important or influential person

2. A bone to pick

Meaning: A dispute or grievance to discuss

3. A pain in the neck/rear

Meaning: An annoying or troublesome person or thing

VOCABULARY

4. Across the board

Meaning: Applying to everyone or everything equally

5. All ears

Meaning: Fully listening and paying attention

Article for Reading

A role for India in South-South climate cooperation

COP29, at Baku, Azerbaijan, aptly referred to as the ‘Climate Finance COP,’ has played a crucial role in operationalising core elements of Article 6 of the Paris Agreement (PA). The adoption of Article 6 at Baku represents a renewed focus on the market mechanism which could help countries that are often constrained by limited resources and face difficulties in achieving an economy-wide transition to a carbon-neutral economy. Article 6 has the potential to meet climate ambitions through cooperative approaches. Its key component, Article 6.2, facilitates the transfer of Internationally Transferred Mitigation Outcomes (ITMOs) between host and partner country to help countries meet their Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), by offering flexibility for tailored agreements. The process not only supports emissions reductions in the host country (developing country) but also fosters technology exchange, promotes capacity building, and facilitates financial resources from the partner country (developed country), helping in the transition to a low-carbon economy and reaching the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

India, which is considered to the third largest emitter of greenhouse gases (GHG), though in absolute terms only, and a rapidly growing economy, is well-positioned to draw benefits from Article 6.2. The country has had a challenge in balancing its developmental goals with its climate commitments due to a lack of adequate finance and also a lack of support from developed countries. India's NDCs, inter alia, include ambitious targets, such as reducing emissions intensity by 45% by 2030. However, the financial and technical constraints are considerable, as just before COP29, India reiterated its call for the developed nations to mobilise at least $1 trillion annually in climate finance for developing countries to meet the challenges of global warming. It is an opportune time for India as it moves to its own domestic emissions trading scheme (ETS), launched as a Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) in 2023, with the aim of integrating market mechanisms into national policy.

While not directly linked to Article 6.2, the CCTS proposes to strengthen India's institutions by providing a framework for transparent carbon credit tracking and verification. India's prior experience with the Clean Development Mechanism (CDM), voluntary carbon market (VCM), Energy Saving Certificates (ESCerts) and Renewable Energy Certificates (REC), has laid the groundwork for effective engagement with international carbon markets under Article 6.2, unlocking opportunities for emission reduction projects and climate finance. India has identified 14 key activities for international collaboration under Article 6.2, which include Renewable Energy (RE), energy storage, and Carbon Capture, Utilization, and Storage programme. These technologies, such as green hydrogen and sustainable aviation fuel, require advanced expertise, research and significant investment, which India seeks through partnerships with leading nations such as South Korea, the European Union, and Japan.

Summary

COP29, held in Baku, Azerbaijan, has been pivotal in advancing the implementation of Article 6 of the Paris Agreement, particularly its market mechanisms under Article 6.2. This provision enables the transfer of Internationally Transferred Mitigation Outcomes (ITMOs) between countries, allowing developing nations to leverage financial and technological support from developed nations to meet their Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) and transition to a low-carbon economy. India, as the third-largest greenhouse gas emitter, stands to benefit significantly from Article 6.2, especially in light of its ambitious climate targets, such as reducing emissions intensity by 45% by 2030. However, financial and technical constraints remain a challenge. India's newly launched Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) in 2023 aims to enhance domestic emissions trading and align with international carbon markets. The country has also identified 14 key areas for collaboration, including renewable energy, energy storage, and carbon capture, seeking partnerships with nations like South Korea, the EU, and Japan to facilitate technological advancements and climate finance.

Tone:

The tone of the passage is informative and analytical. It provides a detailed explanation of COP29's significance, the role of Article 6.2 in climate finance, and India's position in leveraging international cooperation for sustainable development. The passage also reflects a forward-looking and strategic perspective, emphasizing opportunities and challenges in India's climate commitments.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Why is India well-positioned to benefit from Article 6.2?

a) It is the largest emitter of greenhouse gases (GHG) in the world.
b) It has surplus financial resources to fund climate initiatives independently.
c) It has prior experience with emissions reduction mechanisms and is launching its own carbon trading scheme.
d) It has already achieved all of its Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs).
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What has India urged developed nations to do before COP29?

a) Completely eliminate fossil fuel production by 2030
b) Mobilise at least $1 trillion annually in climate finance for developing nations
c) Prioritise emissions reductions over economic growth
d) Ban carbon trading to ensure environmental integrity
e) None of the above

Question 3:
What is one of the main challenges India faces in meeting its climate commitments?

a) Lack of clear policy direction on climate change
b) Limited availability of domestic natural resources for renewable energy
c) Overdependence on nuclear power as a primary energy source
d) Inadequate financial and technical support from developed nations
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Self-inflicted injury: On Trump tariffs and the U.S. economy

Economic estimates from United States President Donald Trump's first term suggest that the sweeping tariffs his administration imposed on nearly $400 billion worth of goods hurt the American economy. They also resulted in a net loss in real (inflation-adjusted) Gross Domestic Product (GDP), a decline in annual household income, and job losses in the manufacturing sector. A 2019 discussion paper by the Federal Reserve Board, Disentangling the Effects of the 2018-2019 Tariffs on a Globally Connected U.S. Manufacturing Sector, found that industries most exposed to tariff increases saw relative reductions in employment. The negative effects of rising input costs and retaliatory tariffs outweighed the benefits of import protection, leading to a net decline in manufacturing jobs, an estimated 0.6% loss, or about 75,000 fewer jobs than would have existed without the tariffs.

Similarly, a 2019 report from the Congressional Budget Office (CBO), ‘An Update to the Budget and Economic Outlook: 2019 to 2029’, projected that trade barriers would reduce U.S. economic output. By 2020, the CBO estimated a 0.3% decline in real GDP and a $580 reduction in average real household income (in 2019 dollars). The 25% tariff on iron and steel imports by Mr. Trump, in his second term, mirrors a similar policy from March 2018. In his first term, Canada, Mexico and the European Union were initially exempted until June 2018, after which retaliatory tariffs followed until a truce was reached in May 2019 through a revised North American trade agreement. Economists have pointed to these tariffs, which continued to a large extent under the Biden administration, being one of the factors that contributed to high inflation in recent years.

In 2023, China dominated global steel production with 1,019 million metric tons per annum (mmtpa), accounting for 54% of global output, followed by India (140.8 mmtpa, 7%) and the U.S. (81.4 mmtpa, 4%). Despite its domestic production, the U.S. relies heavily on imports from Canada, Mexico, and Brazil. Steel is a critical material across industries, including automotive, construction, appliances, and oil and gas. While the American steel industry has welcomed the new tariffs, imports are unlikely to decrease immediately, as a global surplus, driven by China, keeps prices competitive. Even a slight increase in steel prices could ripple across the economy, raising costs for consumers struggling with affordability. If history is any indication, Mr. Trump's tariffs may be the start of another round of self-inflicted economic damage for an already strained U.S. economy, albeit still the world's largest.

Question 4:
Which of the following best describes the impact of the 25% tariff on iron and steel imports under Trump's presidency?

a) It significantly boosted U.S. domestic steel production, eliminating the need for imports.
b) It led to immediate reductions in U.S. steel imports.
c) It had little immediate effect on imports due to a global steel surplus.
d) It decreased U.S. dependence on Chinese steel imports.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Which statement best summarizes the passage's overall argument regarding Trump's steel tariffs?

a) The tariffs were an effective protectionist measure that strengthened U.S. manufacturing.
b) The tariffs had mixed results, benefiting some industries while harming others.
c) The tariffs were necessary to counter China's dominance in steel production.
d) The tariffs largely backfired, causing economic damage and job losses.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question

Original Text:

The collapse of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB) in March 2023 was one of the largest bank failures in U.S. history, sending shockwaves through financial markets and the tech industry. SVB, a key lender to startups and venture capital firms, suffered a rapid downfall due to poor risk management, rising interest rates, and a bank run by depositors.

SVB's troubles began when it invested heavily in long-term U.S. Treasury bonds, which lost value as the Federal Reserve raised interest rates to combat inflation. To cover losses, the bank attempted to raise funds, triggering panic among depositors—mostly startups and tech firms—who rushed to withdraw their money. The mass withdrawal drained SVB's liquidity, forcing regulators to seize the bank.

The collapse had significant repercussions. Startups faced funding challenges, stock markets reacted negatively, and confidence in the banking sector weakened. The U.S. government and the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC) stepped in to protect depositors, preventing wider financial contagion.

SVB's failure highlighted the risks of poor asset management, interest rate sensitivity, and over-reliance on a concentrated customer base. It underscored the need for stronger risk controls and diversification in banking operations to prevent similar crises in the future.

Precis

The collapse of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB) in March 2023 resulted from poor risk management, rising interest rates, and a bank run. Heavy investments in long-term bonds lost value as the Federal Reserve raised rates, leading to a liquidity crisis and mass withdrawals.

The failure impacted startups, stock markets, and banking confidence, prompting FDIC intervention. The crisis exposed risks in asset management and deposit concentration, emphasizing the need for stronger risk controls and diversification in banking.

- **You have received a job offer but have decided to decline it. Write a formal email to the HR department expressing your decision professionally.**

To: ……..@gmail.com

Subject: Declining the Job Offer – [Your Name]

Dear [HR Representative’s Name],

I hope you are doing well. I sincerely appreciate the offer for the [Job Title] position at [Company Name] and the time and effort your team has invested in the hiring process. It was a pleasure learning about the company and the exciting opportunities it offers.

After careful consideration, I have decided to decline the offer at this time. This was not an easy decision, as I hold [Company Name] in high regard, but I believe it is the best course of action for me at this stage of my career.

I truly appreciate the opportunity and the support extended to me throughout the process. I hope our paths cross again in the future, and I wish [Company Name] continued success.

Thank you once again for your understanding.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Match the column

1. A big shot	A. An annoying or troublesome person or thing
2. A bone to pick	B. Applying to everyone or everything equally
3. A pain in the neck/rear	C. An important or influential person
4. Across the board	D. Fully listening and paying attention
5. All ears	E. A dispute or grievance to discuss

Answer:

1-c

2-e

3-a

4-b

5-d

Vocabulary

1. Foster:
2. Retaliatory:
3. Ripple:
4. Constrained:
5. Repercussions:
6. Exorbitant:
7. Pervasive:
8. Impetus:
9. Requisite:
10. Flaccid:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: c

Explanation:

India has experience with carbon trading mechanisms like the Clean Development Mechanism (CDM), voluntary carbon markets (VCM), and Energy Saving Certificates (ESCerts). It has also introduced its Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) in 2023, which strengthens its readiness to engage in international carbon markets under Article 6.2.

Reference:

"India’s prior experience with the Clean Development Mechanism (CDM), voluntary carbon market (VCM), Energy Saving Certificates (ESCerts) and Renewable Energy Certificates (REC), has laid the groundwork for effective engagement with international carbon markets under Article 6.2."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – India is the third-largest GHG emitter, not the largest.

b) Incorrect – India faces financial constraints in climate action.

d) Incorrect – India’s NDC targets are ambitious but not yet fully achieved.

2.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Before COP29, India reiterated its demand for developed nations to mobilise at least $1 trillion per year in climate finance to help developing nations meet climate goals.

Reference:

"Just before COP29, India reiterated its call for the developed nations to mobilise at least $1 trillion annually in climate finance for developing countries to meet the challenges of global warming."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – India’s demand was for climate finance, not a fossil fuel ban.

c) Incorrect – The passage does not mention prioritising emissions over growth.

d) Incorrect – India supports carbon trading, not banning it.

3.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The passage mentions that India struggles to balance economic growth with climate goals due to a lack of sufficient finance and support from developed countries.

Reference:

"India, which is considered to be the third largest emitter of greenhouse gases (GHG), though in absolute terms only, and a rapidly growing economy, is well-positioned to draw benefits from Article 6.2. The country has had a challenge in balancing its developmental goals with its climate commitments due to a lack of adequate finance and also a lack of support from developed countries."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – India has a clear policy direction, including the Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS).

b) Incorrect – India is rich in renewable energy resources like solar and wind.

c) Incorrect – India is not over-reliant on nuclear power.

4.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage states that while the American steel industry welcomed the tariffs, imports were unlikely to decrease immediately because a global surplus (led by China) kept prices competitive.

Reference:

"While the American steel industry has welcomed the new tariffs, imports are unlikely to decrease immediately, as a global surplus, driven by China, keeps prices competitive."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The U.S. still relies heavily on imports from Canada, Mexico, and Brazil.

b) Incorrect – Imports did not decrease immediately.

d) Incorrect – The passage does not mention U.S. dependence on Chinese steel imports.

5.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The passage presents evidence from economic reports (Federal Reserve, CBO) showing that Trump’s tariffs led to job losses, reduced GDP, and higher costs. It also warns that new tariffs may cause similar harm.

Reference:

"If history is any indication, Mr. Trump’s tariffs may be the start of another round of self-inflicted economic damage for an already strained U.S. economy."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The tariffs harmed manufacturing rather than strengthening it.

b) Incorrect – The passage focuses primarily on the negative effects.

c) Incorrect – The tariffs were imposed on all steel imports, not just Chinese imports.

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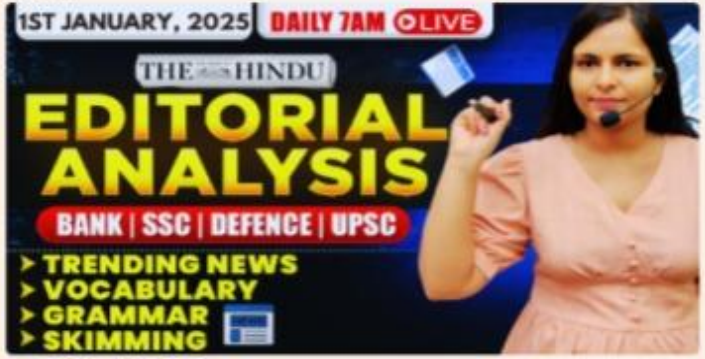

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